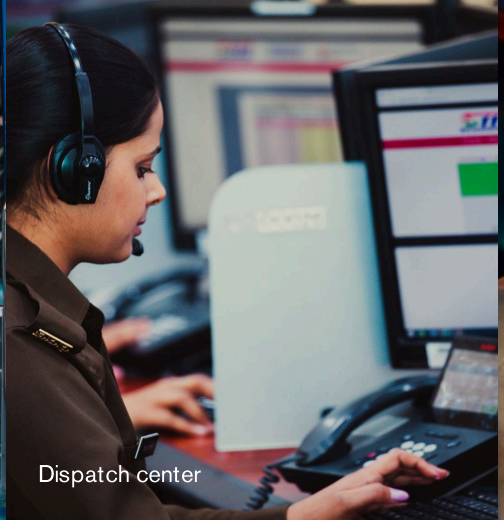

Ambulance crew


Dispatch center


Field responder, XP5plus

White paper · Emergency medical services

Connected care in motion.

How EMS agencies are replacing legacy communications with mission-critical mobility.

The EMS communication challenge

Response times matter. A study of 1.7 million EMS runs found a median response of about 7 minutes, and about 13 minutes in rural areas, where nearly one call in ten waited close to half an hour.[1]

Crews work across hospitals, highways, rural roads, events and disasters, often in one shift. More than 18,200 local EMS agencies answer about 28.5 million 911 dispatches a year.[2] Every call is a chain of conversations, and when communication fails, care is delayed.

Legacy land mobile radio (LMR) has limits. Coverage ends where the towers end, and every expansion means more sites and more capital. Meanwhile, the job now runs on more than voice:

Voice · Data · Video · GPS location · Patient information

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1 Mell HK et al., JAMA Surgery, 2017. 2 NASEMSO, 2020 National EMS Assessment.
Photos: Pexels (free license), Sonim.

Today's EMS teams need:

- ✓ Instant PTT communication
- ✓ Reliable coverage beyond radio range
- ✓ Rugged devices built for frontline use
- ✓ Dispatch integration
- ✓ Secure connectivity and management

The shift

Why leading EMS agencies are moving beyond traditional radios.

EMS leaders are moving away from treating communications as a radio problem and toward an operational mobility platform: nationwide broadband, standards-based push-to-talk and rugged devices that carry voice and data together.

FirstNet, the public safety network built with AT&T, covers more than 3 million square miles, gives first responders priority and preemption, and serves about 31,000 agencies. More than 190 deployable assets back it up for incidents and planned events.[3]

Mission-critical push-to-talk (MCPTT) brings radio-grade group calling to broadband, and gateways such as FirstNet Fusion Link connect MCPTT talkgroups to existing LMR systems. Agencies can move at their own pace without retiring the radios they already own.[3]

"With FirstNet, we maintain contact with first responders nationwide during everyday crises and large disasters."

Jeffrey E. Marani

National Director of Field Technologies, Global Medical Response[3]

3 FirstNet.com: EMS solutions; FirstNet Fusion; "Global Medical Response Connects Disaster Teams & Paramedics."

Traditional LMR		Modern mission-critical mobility
Coverage limits	→	Nationwide coverage
Voice only	→	Voice + data + video
Costly infrastructure	→	Carrier-powered
Separate devices	→	Consolidated platform
Limited flexibility	→	Rapid deployment

18,200+

Local EMS agencies answering 911 calls[2]

28.5M

911 dispatches a year in 41 reporting states[2]

~31,000

Public safety agencies on FirstNet[3]

EMS use cases

Ambulance operations

Crew-to-dispatch communications from the rig or on foot.

Interfacility transport

Real-time coordination between sending and receiving locations.

Special events

Large crowds and mass casualty readiness.

Disaster response

Deployable communications in disrupted environments.

Air medical operations

Aircraft tracking and remote connectivity.

See GMR, page 4

2 NASEMSO, 2020 National EMS Assessment. 3 FirstNet.com: EMS solutions; FirstNet Fusion.

Customer spotlight

How EMS organizations use Sonim today.



Case study

Global Medical Response (GMR)

7,254 ground ambulances · 404 rotor-wing and 114 fixed-wing aircraft · ~5.5M patient encounters a year[4]

Challenge

Remote aircraft tracking, weak coverage and environmental extremes at air bases and landing zones.

Solution

Sonim MegaConnect HPUE with FirstNet connectivity: Power Class 1 on Band 14, up to 6x the signal strength and 2x the upload speed of a standard hotspot, with external antenna ports.[5]

Results

- Faster deployment
- Stronger connectivity
- Improved performance in remote locations
- Reliable operation in demanding environments

GMR has also deployed 1,200 FirstNet-capable Sonim XP8 smartphones to support crisis and disaster response.[3]



Case study

Star EMS

Oakland County, Michigan · 911 and non-emergency transport · in-house 24/7 dispatch center[4]

Challenge

A costly LMR system with limited scalability. Growing the fleet meant more radio infrastructure.

Solution

Sonim XP5plus, Kodiak Dispatch and a FirstNet communications platform. Dispatchers make PTT calls, monitor talkgroups and see crew locations from a web console.

Benefits

- Rugged frontline communications
- Improved dispatch coordination
- Centralized visibility
- Scalable communications platform

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3 FirstNet.com, "Global Medical Response Connects Disaster Teams & Paramedics."
4 globalmedicalresponse.com; starems.com. 5 sonimtech.com, MegaConnect. Photos: Pexels (free license).

The Sonim EMS solution stack

The EMS communications ecosystem.

More than a handset: device, connectivity, accessories and management, working as one system on AT&T and FirstNet.

01



XP5plus 5G

Fourth-generation radio-style handset for PTT-first crews. AT&T Enhanced PTT, FirstNet Rapid Response and FirstNet MCPTT.[5]

Dedicated PTT
Side-mounted key

SOS button
Top-mounted key

Glove-friendly
Large, tactile keys

Removable battery
Up to 25 hr talk

FirstNet Ready
Band 14 certified

Ultra-rugged
IP68 · MIL-STD-810H

02



MegaConnect

The first ultra-portable 5G HPUE hotspot, with 2.5 Gbps Ethernet and four external antenna ports.[5]

Stronger connectivity
Up to 6x signal

FirstNet MegaRange
HPUE Power Class 1

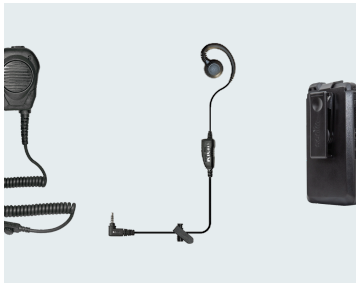
Mobile deployment
Battery-powered

Vehicle operations
External antennas

Incident command
Up to 64 devices

5 sonimtech.com: XP5plus 5G, MegaConnect.

03

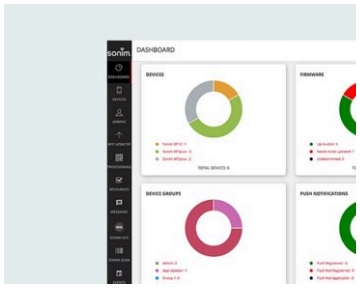


Accessories partners

Speaker mics, headsets, chargers, vehicle mounts and carry solutions.

RAM Mounts	AdvanceTec	Klein
OTTO	AINA	Stone Mountain

04



Management & services

Kodiak Dispatch
PTT calls, talkgroups, GPS location

Sonim Cloud
Remote setup, updates, monitoring

SonimWare
SafeGuard, Kiosk Mode, SOS app

Support services
SonimCare / FirstCare

The real story

No longer a radio problem.

EMS organizations are treating communications as an operational mobility platform. Devices like the Sonim XP5plus, connectivity such as MegaConnect, and integrated dispatch and management tools improve situational awareness, coverage, coordination and resilience while reducing dependence on traditional radio infrastructure.

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5 sonimtech.com: SonimWare. Partner logos pending approval.